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Then There Were Three

Amtrak shortlists three master developer teams to transform Penn Station

By [Daniel Jonas Roche](#) • January 21, 2026 • [Architecture](#), [East](#), [News](#), [Transportation](#)



Penn Station shrouded in scaffolding ([Ajay Suresh/Wikimedia Commons/CC BY 2.0](#))

U.S. Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy and Amtrak special advisor Andy Byford announced a major competition for Penn Station’s redesign last August. That month, Duffy and Byford solicited a master developer to oversee a monumental public-private partnership (P3) for the train hall’s transformation.

Yesterday, Amtrak announced three shortlisted “master developers” for New York Penn Station’s redesign. The shortlisted groups are: Penn Forward Now, led by Fengate Capital; Penn Transformation Now, by Halmar International; and Grand Penn Partners, by Macquarie Capital.



Fengate is a leading North American infrastructure investor and developer founded in 2006. It is partnering with SOM, ARUP, and Grimshaw on the Penn Station project, according to the Penn Forward Now website. ARUP was awarded a contract from Amtrak in 2022 to design options for new tracks, platforms, and concourses at Penn Station. This group has not yet shared renderings.

Halmar International is a New York-based heavy civil construction management firm. It is partnering with PAU and ASTM, an Italian group. The PAU/ASTM proposal, where it stood prior to the shortlisting, would leave Madison Square Garden (MSG) in place. Its modern stone facade would be proportioned to respect the original Penn Station.

Macquarie Capital is a unit of global financial services firm Macquarie Group. The Macquarie proposal would reconstruct elements of the original Beaux-Arts Penn Station by McKim, Mead & White. It would relocate MSG across Seventh Avenue.



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Renaissance Rails, led by Richard Cameron and Fred Knapp, was not listed as part of a shortlisted P3 group, although Cameron is credited with first championing the effort to rebuild the original Beaux-Arts Penn Station, an idea later adopted by Justin Shubow of the National Civic Art Society and Alexandros Washburn, executive director of Grand Penn Community Alliance.



As previously reported, a Federal Railroad Administration (FRA) study underway will “evaluate ways to safely accommodate passenger growth throughout the tri-state region and maximize train capacity within the confines of the existing station footprint.” Byford has previously said he is receptive to implementing full-through running service at Penn Station and relocating MSG.

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ReThinkNYC, which has long advocated for through-running at Penn Station, in a statement today said it is “hopeful” the FRA study will “utilize dynamic and industry standard railroad capacity modeling software—generally agreed to be RTC by Berkeley Simulation Software—and show that the neighborhood does not have to be demolished to accomplish satisfactory capacity increases needed at Penn Station with the advent of the pending Gateway Tunnels.”

The winning P3 will be announced in May 2026, and then preliminary design will start. Byford and Duffy said they want shovels in the ground by the end of 2027.

Correction: The Macquarie consortium does not include the National Civic Art Society or Grand Penn Community Alliance. The article was updated January 22.

Amtrak ARUP Grimshaw Architects Infrastructure PAU Penn Station SOM
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